Tonight 04/11: body shape and quick play (60 min)

Block 3, week 1, Wednesday 04/11/2026. Theme: Look, open, forward, quick. Cue: “Look, open, forward, quick.”

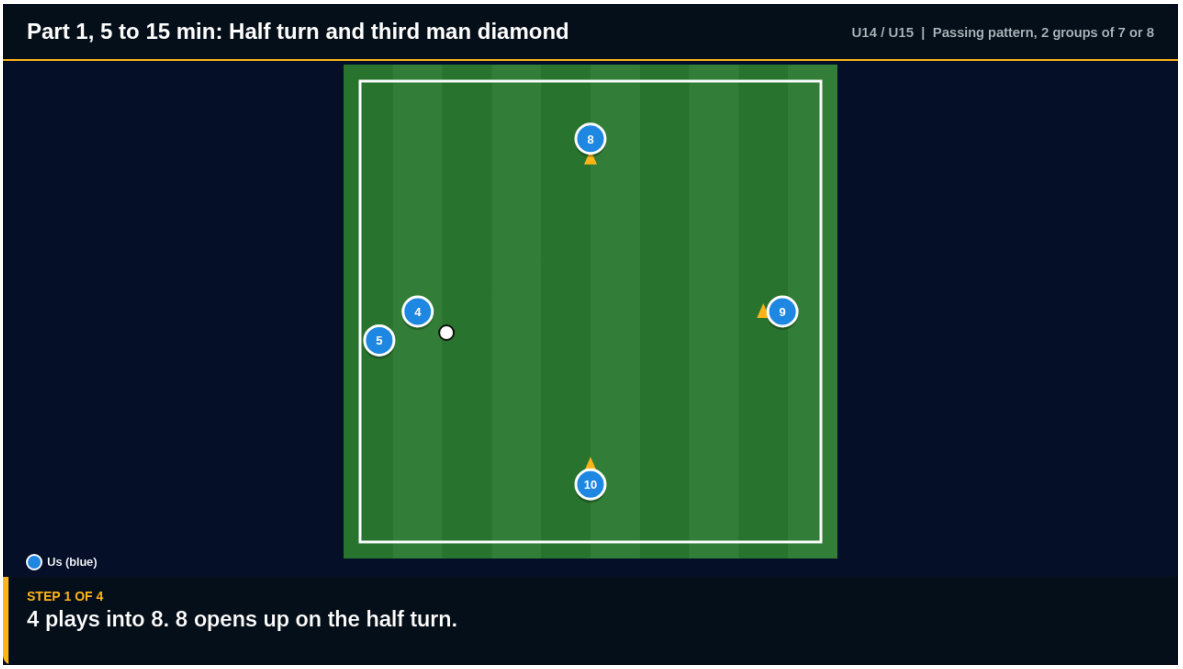
For parents and players: Watch for players looking over their shoulder before the ball arrives, opening their body on the half turn, and moving the ball on in one or two touches. When we win it, the first pass goes forward. Players are shown by shirt number. Blue is us, red is the opposition.

Running order, 60 minutes

0 to 5 min	Warm up and tonight's focus	5 min
5 to 15 min	Half turn and third man diamond	10 min
15 to 25 min	PSV rondo to counter	10 min
25 to 37 min	Scan and play 4v4 plus 3	12 min
37 to 39 min	Drinks	2 min
39 to 49 min	6v4 counter attack with a free zone	10 min
49 to 57 min	3-5-2 game with a touch limit	8 min
57 to 60 min	Stretching card and 3 questions	3 min

Part 1, 5 to 15 min: Half turn and third man diamond

Passing pattern, 2 groups of 7 or 8, Diamond of 4 cones, 15 yards apart. 4 cones per group, 2 balls per group



SET UP

- 2 groups. A diamond of 4 cones, 15 yards apart.
- 2 at the bottom cone, 1 or 2 at each other cone.

RULES

- Two touches, then one touch for the set.
- Follow your pass.

HOW IT STARTS

- Number 4 starts with the ball at the bottom cone
- Mirror the pattern to the right after 4 minutes.

WHAT HAPPENS

1. 4 plays into 8. 8 opens up on the half turn.
2. 8 plays forward into 9. Two touches. 4 follows his pass.
3. 10 is already moving. 9 sets it back to the third man.
4. 10 plays into 5 at the start. Go again.

COACHING POINTS

- Open your body, receive on the back foot.
- Two looks before the ball arrives.
- The third man moves early, not after the pass.

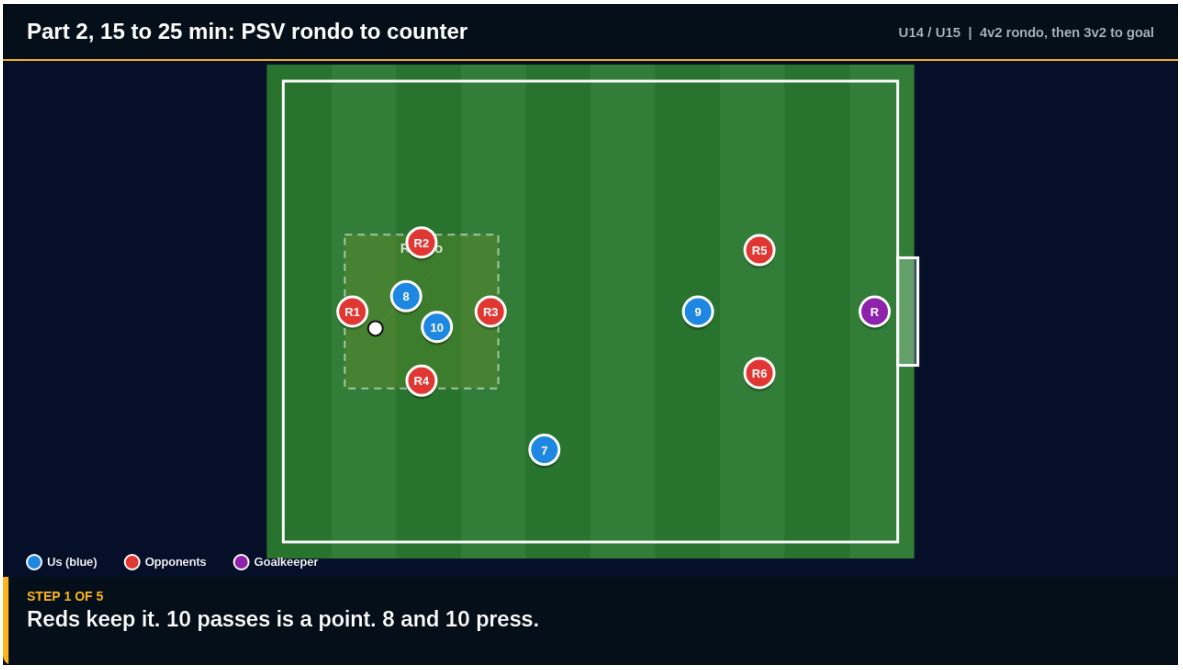
MAKE IT HARDER

- A coach behind 8 shouts turn or man on.

- One touch for the set.

Part 2, 15 to 25 min: PSV rondo to counter

4v2 rondo, then 3v2 to goal, 10 x 10 yard square at the edge of the box. Cones, blue and red bibs, a keeper



SET UP

- A 10 x 10 yard square at the edge of the box: 4 reds against our 2.
- Outside: our striker against 2 centre backs and a keeper, runners waiting.

RULES

- Reds: 10 passes is a point.
- Blues: win it and score within 10 seconds.

HOW IT STARTS

- The reds start with the ball in the square
- Swap the pressers every 2 minutes.

WHAT HAPPENS

1. Reds keep it. 10 passes is a point. 8 and 10 press.
2. 8 wins it.
3. First pass forward, straight into 9.
4. 10 and 7 break. 9 lays it off to 10.
5. 10 hits it early. Goal!

COACHING POINTS

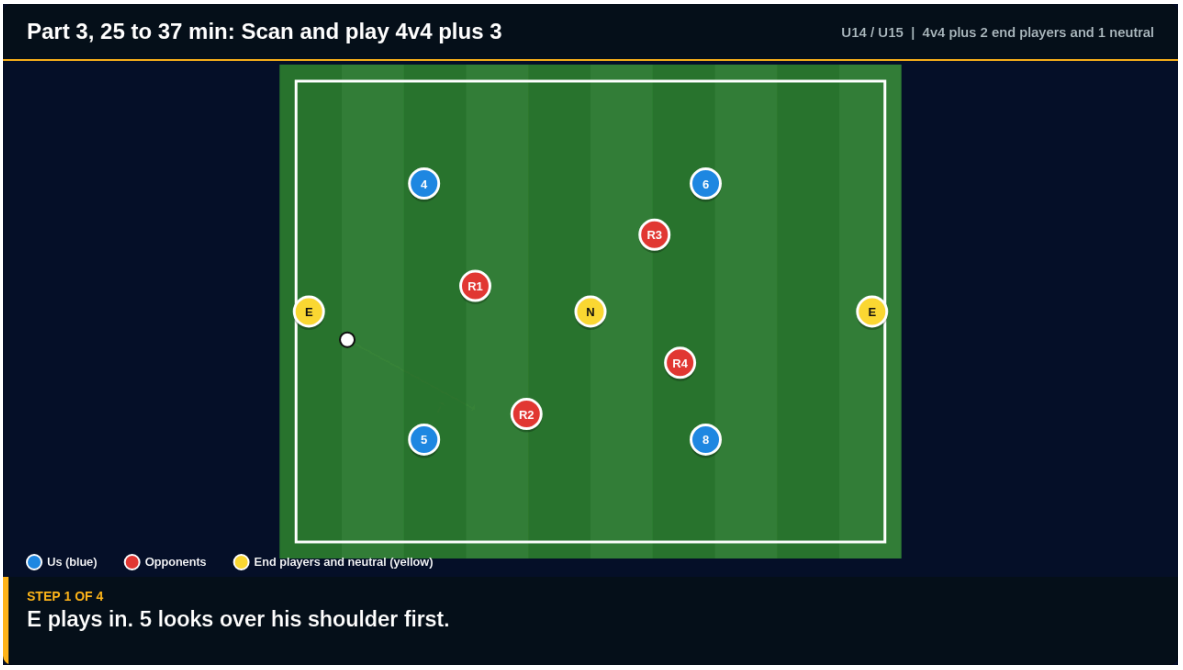
- Press together, cut the inside pass.
- First pass forward and quick.
- Runners go on the regain, not after.

MAKE IT HARDER

- Add a red recovery runner.
- Score within 8 seconds.

Part 3, 25 to 37 min: Scan and play 4v4 plus 3

4v4 plus 2 end players and 1 neutral, 25 x 20 yards. Blue, red and yellow bibs, plenty of balls



SET UP

- 25 x 20 yards. 4 blues against 4 reds inside.
- One end player at each end and one neutral in the middle, in yellow.

RULES

- Inside players two touches, end players and the neutral one touch.
- End to end is a point. Lose it and the other team goes end to end.

HOW IT STARTS

- An end player (E) starts with the ball
- 3 x 3 minutes. Rotate the end players and the neutral.

WHAT HAPPENS

1. E plays in. 5 looks over his shoulder first.
2. 5 is open, so he plays forward first time to N.
3. The neutral sets to 8, who is already moving.
4. 8 plays to the far end player. Point.

COACHING POINTS

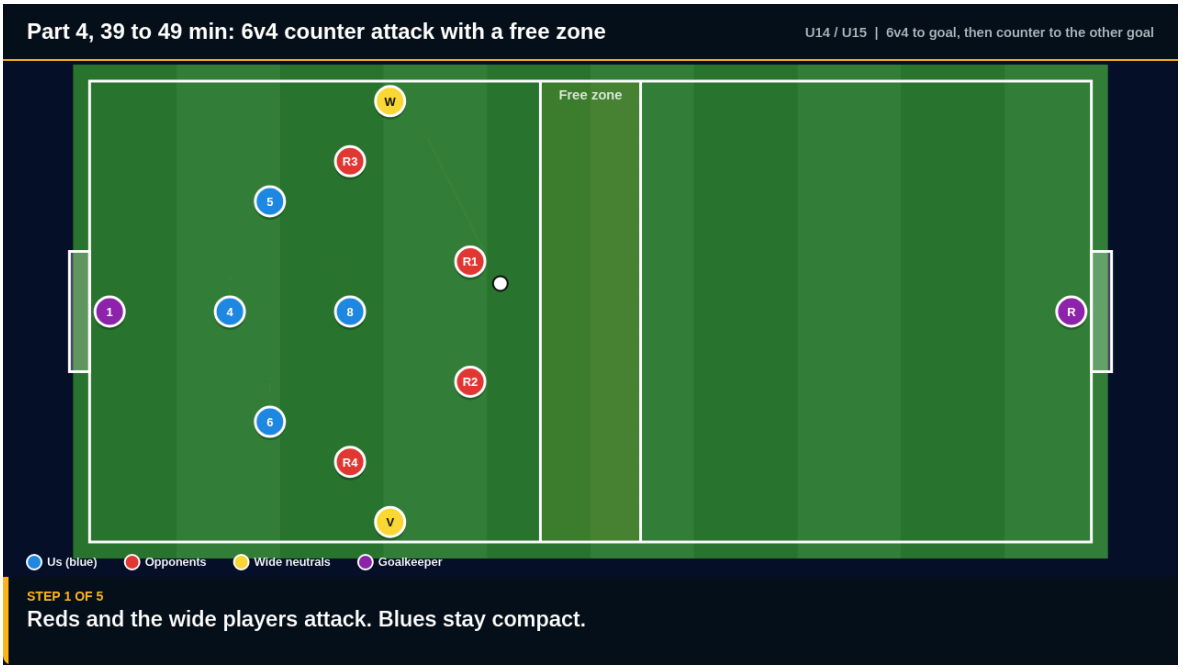
- Check before you get it.
- Open up so you can see the far end.
- Pass, then move to make a new angle.

MAKE IT HARDER

- Coach calls a colour, the next receiver shouts it.
- A point through a third man counts double.

Part 4, 39 to 49 min: 6v4 counter attack with a free zone

6v4 to goal, then counter to the other goal, 25 x 55 yards, 5 yard free zone in the middle. 2 goals, keepers, blue, red and yellow bibs



SET UP

- 25 x 55 yards with a 5 yard free zone in the middle and a goal at each end.
- 4 reds plus 2 wide neutrals attack our 4 defenders.

RULES

- Win it: break and score at the other end.
- No offside in the free zone.

HOW IT STARTS

- The reds start with the ball in their half
- 2 x 4 minutes, then swap roles.

WHAT HAPPENS

1. Reds and the wide players attack. Blues stay compact.
2. The ball comes inside. 4 steps in and wins it.
3. First pass forward into 8.
4. GO! 5 and 6 sprint through the free zone.
5. 5 hits it early. Goal!

COACHING POINTS

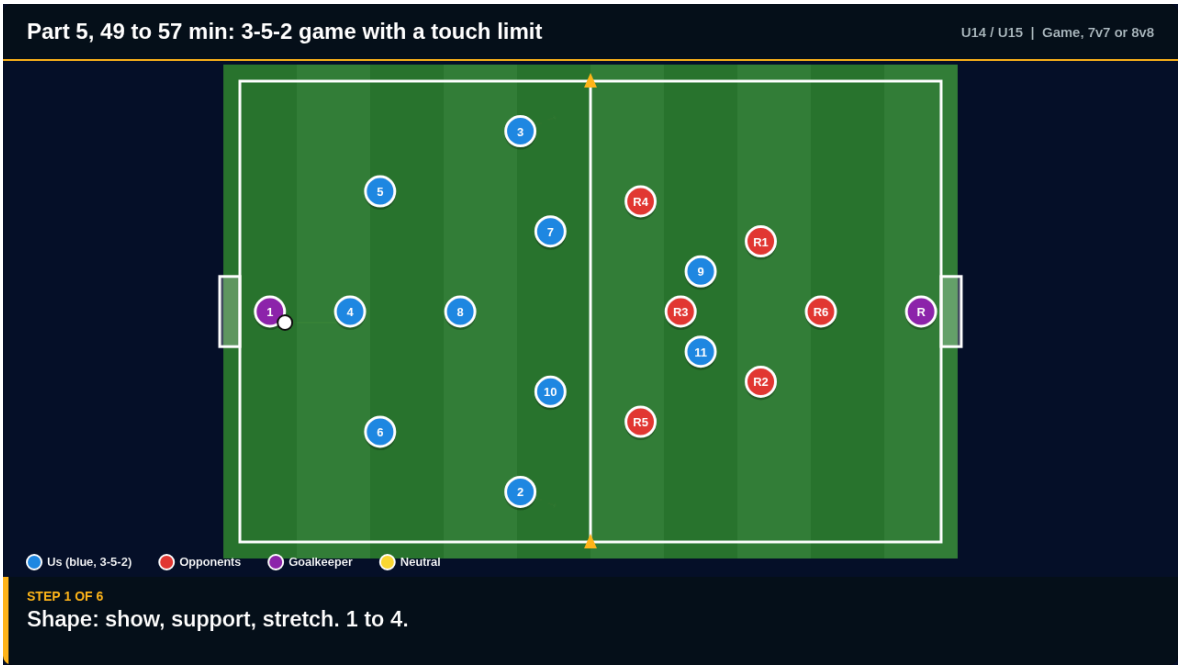
- Stay compact, then go at full speed.
- First pass forward.
- Reds: react the instant you lose it.

MAKE IT HARDER

- Score within 10 seconds.
- Wide neutrals join the blue break as wing backs.

Part 5, 49 to 57 min: 3-5-2 game with a touch limit

Game, 7v7 or 8v8, About 70 x 45 yards. Blue and Red bibs



SET UP

- About 70 x 45 yards, two full sized goals and keepers.
- Play 7v7 or 8v8 with whatever numbers turn up.

RULES

- Three touches at most. The coach can call two touch.
- Win it: 10 seconds to shoot. Lose it: 5 seconds to win it back.

HOW IT STARTS

- Our keeper starts
- Normal restarts. 57 to 60: Stretching card and 3 questions.

WHAT HAPPENS

1. Shape: show, support, stretch. 1 to 4.
2. 4 forward to 7.
3. Lost it! Press for five seconds.
4. Won back by 8, three runners go.
5. 8 to 11, finish.
6. Goal.

COACHING POINTS

- Look before you get it.
- Open on the half turn, forward first.
- React instantly when it turns over.

MAKE IT HARDER

- Goals from a third man pass count double.
- Last 2 minutes free play.

Watch the animated session with voice over in the Touchline family app. Wigan Junior Latics.